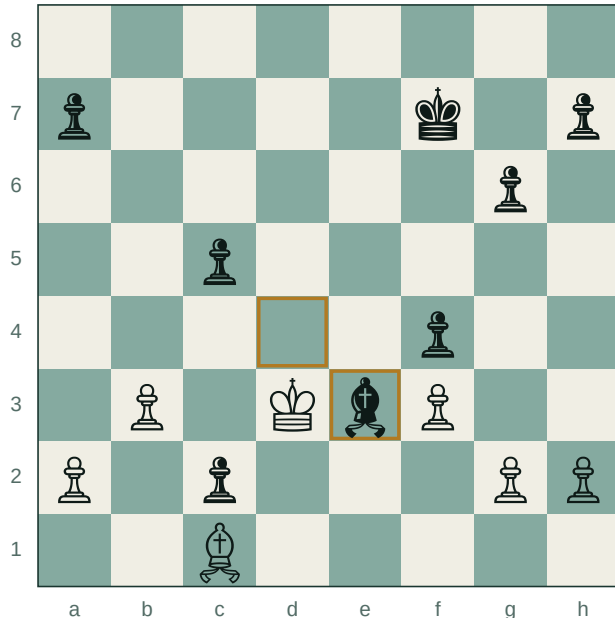


Bishop-ending decisions: White, move 38

Bishop-ending decisions

White to move



Previous move: 37...Be3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Bxe3 fxe3 39. Kxc2 e2 40. Kd2 e1=N 41. Kxe1

38.Bxe3 The bishop captures the bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **38...fxe3**.

39.Kxc2 The king captures the pawn on c2. Recorded reply: **39...e2**.

40.Kd2 The king moves from c2 to d2. Recorded reply: **40...e1=N**.

41.Kxe1 The king captures the knight on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on f7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.